



11094 - Linking protoplanetary disks to the Solar System: Tracing the chemical evolution of ices

Cycle: 5, Proposal Category: GO

INVESTIGATORS

<i>Name</i>	<i>Institution</i>
Dr. Ryo Tazaki (PI)	University of Tokyo
Dr. Mitsuhiro Honda (CoI)	Okayama University of Science
Dr. Christian Ginski (CoI) (ESA Member)	University of Galway
Jun Hashimoto (CoI)	National Astronomical Observatory of Japan (NAOJ)
Dr. Taichi Uyama (CoI)	National Institute for Basic Biology
Dr. Julien Milli (CoI) (ESA Member)	Institut de Planetologie et d'Astrophysique de Grenoble
Dr. Hideko Nomura (CoI)	National Astronomical Observatory of Japan (NAOJ)
Dr. Shota Notsu (CoI)	University of Tokyo, Graduate School of Science
Mr. Kanon Nakazawa (CoI)	Institute of Science Tokyo
Prof. Satoshi Okuzumi (CoI)	Institute of Science Tokyo
Dr. Chen Xie (CoI)	The Johns Hopkins University
Dr. Sarah Betti (CoI)	Space Telescope Science Institute
Dr. Christine Chen (CoI) (US Admin CoI) (Contact)	The Johns Hopkins University

OBSERVATIONS

<i>Folder</i>	<i>Observation</i>	<i>Label</i>	<i>Observing Template</i>	<i>Science Target</i>
AB Aur				
	1	AB Aur IFU SPEC	NIRSpec IFU Spectroscopy	(1) AB Aur
	2	AB Aur PSF CAL	NIRSpec IFU Spectroscopy	(3) 14Aur-PSFcal-AB Aur
HD142527				
	3	HD142527 IFU SPEC	NIRSpec IFU Spectroscopy	(5) HD-142527

Folder	Observation	Label	Observing Template	Science Target
	4	HD142527 PSF CAL	NIRSpec IFU Spectroscopy	(7) HD141687-PSFcal-HD142527

ABSTRACT

Volatile ices are the dominant solid components in the cold outer regions of protoplanetary disks and serve as the fundamental building blocks of planets. Yet, their compositions and spatial distributions remain poorly constrained due to the lack of spatially resolved infrared spectroscopy of the disks. We propose NIRSpec IFU observations of two well-studied protoplanetary disks, AB Aur and HD 142527, to obtain the first spatially resolved infrared reflection spectra of volatile ices in disk surface layers. These observations will enable us to detect and characterize multiple ice species, such as H₂O, CO₂, CO, and organic-related features and to infer their abundances using radiative-transfer modeling. Also, by comparing shadowed and illuminated regions within each disk, we will also investigate how stellar UV irradiation affects ice survival and processing. Ultimately, our program will test whether the compositional diversity observed among Kuiper Belt Objects originates from a radial gradient of ice chemistry in their natal protoplanetary disks, thus linking the chemical evolution from planet-forming disks to the Solar System.

OBSERVING DESCRIPTION

We propose to obtain NIRSpec IFU observations of the protoplanetary disk around AB Aur and HD142527 to trace the ice absorption distribution in the disk. Our primary target ice is H₂O (3.1 μ m), CO₂ (4.26 μ m), and CO (4.67 μ m). Also, a 2.7- μ m OH dangling bond is key for discerning the ice mixture state. Thus we plan to use two disperser-filter combinations of G235H-F170LP and G395H-F290LP to cover 1.66-3.17 μ m and 2.87-5.27 μ m, respectively, with $R \sim 2700$. The choice of the highest spectral resolution is not to resolve the ice absorption features themselves but to mitigate the effect of detector saturation around the bright central star and the inner disk.

To see the faint structure around the very bright compact central source, we will make PSF (point spread function) reference observations to subtract the central source's halo and speckles patterns. Also, because all of the targets and PSF calibration stars are too bright for the WATA or MSATA target acquisition process, we first perform target acquisition using a nearby faint source and then apply an offset from it to place our science target and its PSF reference star in the right position (a WATA blind offset).

Proposal 11094 - Targets - Linking protoplanetary disks to the Solar System: Tracing the chemical evolution of ices

Fixed Targets	#	Name	Target Coordinates	Targ. Coord. Corrections	Miscellaneous
	(1)	ABAur	RA: 04 55 45.8509 (73.9410454d) Dec: +30 33 3.91 (30.55109d) Equinox: J2000	Proper Motion RA: 4.01844124078382 mas/yr Proper Motion Dec: -24.02653395985248 mas/yr Parallax: 0.0064127" Epoch of Position: 2016	
	Comments: Gaia DR3 source_id: 156917493449670656 Category=Star Description=[A stars, Protoplanetary disks] Extended=YES				
	(2)	ABAur-WATA	RA: 04 55 50.7706 (73.9615442d) Dec: +30 32 51.21 (30.54756d) Equinox: J2000	Proper Motion RA: 0.03066769846598 mas/yr Proper Motion Dec: -4.53567414904453 mas/yr Parallax: 0.0006276" Epoch of Position: 2016	
	Comments: Gaia DR3 source_id: 156916771895164160 2MASS J : 13.929 Category=Unidentified Description=[Infrared sources] Extended=NO				
	(3)	14Aur-PSFcal-ABAur	RA: 05 15 24.3622 (78.8515092d) Dec: +32 41 15.56 (32.68766d) Equinox: J2000	Proper Motion RA: -25.25634579770649 mas/yr Proper Motion Dec: 12.33915090041149 mas/yr Parallax: 0.0120126" Epoch of Position: 2016	
	Comments: Gaia DR3 source_id: 180702438220217344 Category=Star Description=[A stars] Extended=NO				
	(4)	14Aur-WATA	RA: 05 15 22.9692 (78.8457050d) Dec: +32 41 52.47 (32.69791d) Equinox: J2000	Proper Motion RA: 1.01784486953215 mas/yr Proper Motion Dec: -3.18953434645219 mas/yr Parallax: 0.0002909" Epoch of Position: 2016	
	Comments: Gaia DR3 source_id: 180702502645705344 2MASS J : 13.953 Category=Unidentified Description=[Infrared sources]				
	(5)	HD-142527	RA: 15 56 41.8725 (239.1744688d) Dec: -42 19 23.67 (-42.32324d) Equinox: J2000	Proper Motion RA: -10.92376545962579 mas/yr Proper Motion Dec: -26.14881451351207 mas/yr Parallax: 0.0062791" Epoch of Position: 2016	
	Comments: Gaia DR3 source_id: 5994826707951507200 Category=Star Description=[F stars, Protoplanetary disks] Extended=YES				
	(6)	HD142527-WATA	RA: 15 56 42.9785 (239.1790771d) Dec: -42 20 13.42 (-42.33706d) Equinox: J2000	Proper Motion RA: 3.79962663386329 mas/yr Proper Motion Dec: 0.00736007537435 mas/yr Parallax: 0.0008931" Epoch of Position: 2016	
	Comments: Gaia DR3 source_id: 5994826604872280832 2MASS J : 12.919 Category=Unidentified Description=[Infrared sources] Extended=NO				

Proposal 11094 - Targets - Linking protoplanetary disks to the Solar System: Tracing the chemical evolution of ices

(7)	HD141687-PSFcal-HD142527 RA: 15 52 13.1426 (238.0547608d) Dec: -45 17 3.62 (-45.28434d) Equinox: J2000 <i>Comments: Gaia DR3 source_id: 5988396386008761600</i> <i>Category=Star</i> <i>Description=[G stars]</i> <i>Extended=NO</i>	Proper Motion RA: -12.83480657370764 mas/yr Proper Motion Dec: 4.79224966220877 mas/yr Parallax: 0.0041352" Epoch of Position: 2016
(8)	HD141687-WATA RA: 15 52 15.2546 (238.0635608d) Dec: -45 17 12.69 (-45.28686d) Equinox: J2000 <i>Comments: Gaia DR3 source_id: 5988396489087970560</i> <i>2MASS J : 12.829</i> <i>Category=Unidentified</i> <i>Description=[Infrared sources]</i> <i>Extended=NO</i>	Proper Motion RA: 8.54349557310039 mas/yr Proper Motion Dec: -9.46294714152439 mas/yr Parallax: 0.0026746" Epoch of Position: 2016

Proposal 11094 - Observation 1 - Linking protoplanetary disks to the Solar System: Tracing the chemical evolution of ices

Observation	Proposal 11094, Observation 1: ABAur IFU SPEC										Mon Jun 01 09:00:12 GMT 2026	
	Diagnostic Status: Warning											
	Observing Template: NIRSspec IFU Spectroscopy											
Diagnostics	(Visit 1:1) Warning (Form): Overheads are provisional until the Visit Planner has been run.											
Fixed Targets	#	Name	Target Coordinates			Targ. Coord. Corrections			Miscellaneous			
	(1)	ABAur	RA: 04 55 45.8509 (73.9410454d) Dec: +30 33 3.91 (30.55109d) Equinox: J2000			Proper Motion RA: 4.01844124078382 mas/yr Proper Motion Dec: -24.02653395985248 mas/yr Parallax: 0.0064127" Epoch of Position: 2016						
	Comments: Gaia DR3 source_id: 156917493449670656 Category=Star Description=[A stars, Protoplanetary disks] Extended=YES											
Acquisition	#	Target	TA Method	Subarray	Filter	Readout Pattern	Groups/Int	Integrations/Exp	Total Integrations	Total Exposure Time	Optional ETC ID	
	1	2 ABAur-WATA	WATA	SUB32	F110W	NRSRAPID	3	1	1	0.08	303882	
Template	HFF Readout Mode											
	false											
Dithers	#	Dither Type			Size	Starting Point		Number of Points		Points		
	1	CYCLING			SMALL	1		16				
Spectral Elements	#	Grating/Filter	Readout Pattern	Groups/Int	Integrations/Exp	Leakcal	Dither	Autocal	Total Dithers	Total Integrations	Total Exposure Time	Optional ETC ID
	1	G235H/F170LP	NRSRAPID	2	5	false	true	NONE	16	80	2576.825	276570
	2	G395H/F290LP	NRSRAPID	2	5	false	true	NONE	16	80	2576.825	276570

Proposal 11094 - Observation 1 - Linking protoplanetary disks to the Solar System: Tracing the chemical evolution of ices

Special Requirements	Aperture PA Range 213.97164917 to 238.97164917 Degrees (V3 75.0 to 100.0) Group Observations 1, 2, Non-interruptible
----------------------	---

Proposal 11094 - Observation 2 - Linking protoplanetary disks to the Solar System: Tracing the chemical evolution of ices

Observation	Proposal 11094, Observation 2: ABAur PSF CAL										Mon Jun 01 09:00:12 GMT 2026	
	Diagnostic Status: Warning											
Diagnostics	Observing Template: NIRSspec IFU Spectroscopy											
	(Visit 2:1) Warning (Form): Overheads are provisional until the Visit Planner has been run.											
Fixed Targets	#	Name	Target Coordinates			Targ. Coord. Corrections			Miscellaneous			
	(3)	14Aur-PSFcal-ABAur	RA: 05 15 24.3622 (78.8515092d) Dec: +32 41 15.56 (32.68766d) Equinox: J2000			Proper Motion RA: -25.25634579770649 mas/yr Proper Motion Dec: 12.33915090041149 mas/yr Parallax: 0.0120126" Epoch of Position: 2016						
Acquisition	Comments: Gaia DR3 source_id: 180702438220217344											
	Category=Star											
	Description=[A stars]											
Acquisition	#	Target	TA Method	Subarray	Filter	Readout Pattern	Groups/Int	Integrations/Exp	Total Integrations	Total Exposure Time	Optional ETC ID	
	1	4 14Aur-WATA	WATA	SUB32	F110W	NRSRAPID	3	1	1	0.08	303882	
Template	HFF Readout Mode											
	false											
Dithers	#	Dither Type			Size	Starting Point		Number of Points		Points		
	1	CYCLING			SMALL	1		16				
Spectral Elements	#	Grating/Filter	Readout Pattern	Groups/Int	Integrations/Exp	Leakcal	Dither	Autocal	Total Dithers	Total Integrations	Total Exposure Time	Optional ETC ID
	1	G235H/F170LP	NRSRAPID	2	5	false	true	NONE	16	80	2576.825	276570
	2	G395H/F290LP	NRSRAPID	2	5	false	true	NONE	16	80	2576.825	276570

Proposal 11094 - Observation 2 - Linking protoplanetary disks to the Solar System: Tracing the chemical evolution of ices

Special Requirements	Group Observations 1, 2, Non-interruptible
----------------------	--

Proposal 11094 - Observation 3 - Linking protoplanetary disks to the Solar System: Tracing the chemical evolution of ices

Observation	Proposal 11094, Observation 3: HD142527 IFU SPEC										Mon Jun 01 09:00:12 GMT 2026	
	Diagnostic Status: Warning											
	Observing Template: NIRSpec IFU Spectroscopy											
Diagnostics	(Visit 3:1) Warning (Form): Overheads are provisional until the Visit Planner has been run.											
Fixed Targets	#	Name	Target Coordinates			Targ. Coord. Corrections			Miscellaneous			
	(5)	HD-142527	RA: 15 56 41.8725 (239.1744688d) Dec: -42 19 23.67 (-42.32324d) Equinox: J2000			Proper Motion RA: -10.92376545962579 mas/yr Proper Motion Dec: -26.14881451351207 mas/yr Parallax: 0.0062791" Epoch of Position: 2016						
	Comments: Gaia DR3 source_id: 5994826707951507200 Category=Star Description=[F stars, Protoplanetary disks] Extended=YES											
Acquisition	#	Target	TA Method	Subarray	Filter	Readout Pattern	Groups/Int	Integrations/Exp	Total Integrations	Total Exposure Time	Optional ETC ID	
	1	6 HD142527-WATA	WATA	SUB32	F110W	NRSRAPID	3	1	1	0.08	303882	
Template	HFF Readout Mode											
	false											
Dithers	#	Dither Type			Size	Starting Point		Number of Points		Points		
	1	CYCLING			SMALL	1		16				
Spectral Elements	#	Grating/Filter	Readout Pattern	Groups/Int	Integrations/Exp	Leakcal	Dither	Autocal	Total Dithers	Total Integrations	Total Exposure Time	Optional ETC ID
	1	G235M/F170LP	NRSRAPID	2	5	false	true	NONE	16	80	2576.825	276570
	2	G395M/F290LP	NRSRAPID	2	5	false	true	NONE	16	80	2576.825	276570

Proposal 11094 - Observation 3 - Linking protoplanetary disks to the Solar System: Tracing the chemical evolution of ices

Special Requirements	Aperture PA Range 233.97164917 to 238.97164917 Degrees (V3 95.0 to 100.0) Group Observations 3, 4, Non-interruptible
----------------------	---

Proposal 11094 - Observation 4 - Linking protoplanetary disks to the Solar System: Tracing the chemical evolution of ices

Observation	Proposal 11094, Observation 4: HD142527 PSF CAL											Mon Jun 01 09:00:12 GMT 2026
	Diagnostic Status: Warning											
	Observing Template: NIRSpec IFU Spectroscopy											
Diagnostics	(Visit 4:1) Warning (Form): Overheads are provisional until the Visit Planner has been run.											
Fixed Targets	#	Name	Target Coordinates				Targ. Coord. Corrections			Miscellaneous		
	(7)	HD141687-PSFcal-HD142527	RA: 15 52 13.1426 (238.0547608d) Dec: -45 17 3.62 (-45.28434d) Equinox: J2000				Proper Motion RA: -12.83480657370764 mas/yr Proper Motion Dec: 4.79224966220877 mas/yr Parallax: 0.0041352" Epoch of Position: 2016					
		Comments: Gaia DR3 source_id: 5988396386008761600										
		Category=Star										
		Description=[G stars]										
	Extended=NO											
Acquisition	#	Target	TA Method	Subarray	Filter	Readout Pattern	Groups/Int	Integrations/Exp	Total Integrations	Total Exposure Time	Optional ETC ID	
	1	8 HD141687-WATA	WATA	SUB32	F110W	NRSRAPID	3	1	1	0.08	303882	
Template	HFF Readout Mode											
	false											
Dithers	#	Dither Type			Size		Starting Point		Number of Points		Points	
	1	CYCLING			SMALL		1		16			
Spectral Elements	#	Grating/Filter	Readout Pattern	Groups/Int	Integrations/Exp	Leakcal	Dither	Autocal	Total Dithers	Total Integrations	Total Exposure Time	Optional ETC ID
	1	G235M/F170LP	NRSRAPID	2	5	false	true	NONE	16	80	2576.825	276570
	2	G395M/F290LP	NRSRAPID	2	5	false	true	NONE	16	80	2576.825	276570

Proposal 11094 - Observation 4 - Linking protoplanetary disks to the Solar System: Tracing the chemical evolution of ices

Special Requirements	Group Observations 3, 4, Non-interruptible
----------------------	--